

SOCIAL ISSUES IN INFORMATION SOCIETY

TAKE-HOME ASSIGNMENT

THE MORPHOLOGY OF UNCERTAINTY:

POWER AND CONTROL IN THE DIGITAL AGE

DANIELA LORRIZ BAUTISTA - ID. 900074

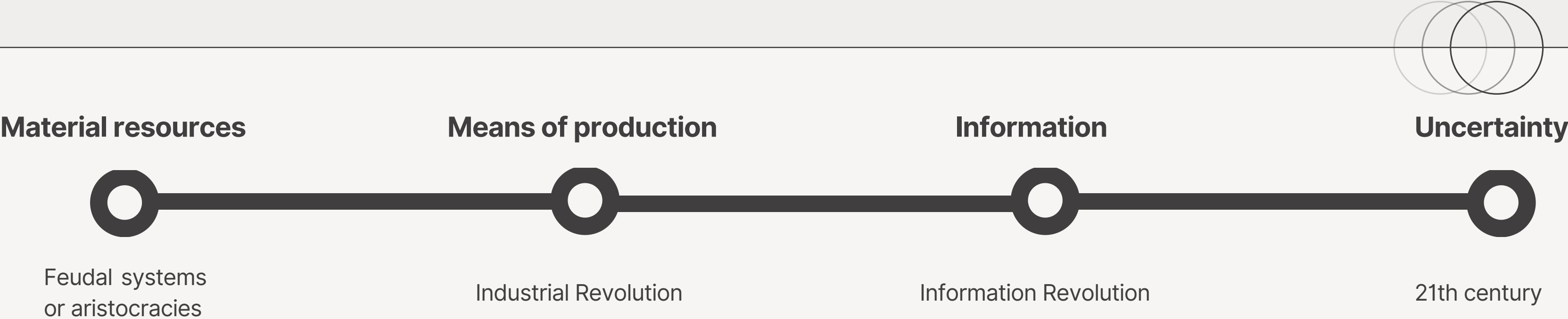
MATTEO FUMAGALLI - ID. 894468

RISHPA SHRESTHA - ID. 947788

PAGE 1

From Traditional Power to the Morphology of Uncertainty

“Whoever controls uncertainty controls society” - Luciano Floridi



MORPHOLOGY OF UNCERTAINTY

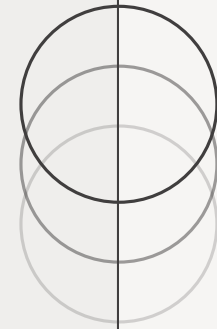
Structure, shape, and distribution of the gap between questions and answers

Uncertainty as a Tool of Digital Governance

Uncertainty is no longer a limitation, rather a powerful resource that is produced and strategically employed

Governance operates at the **infrastructural level**

It shapes human behaviours not by issuing explicit commands



Platform-Driven Governance



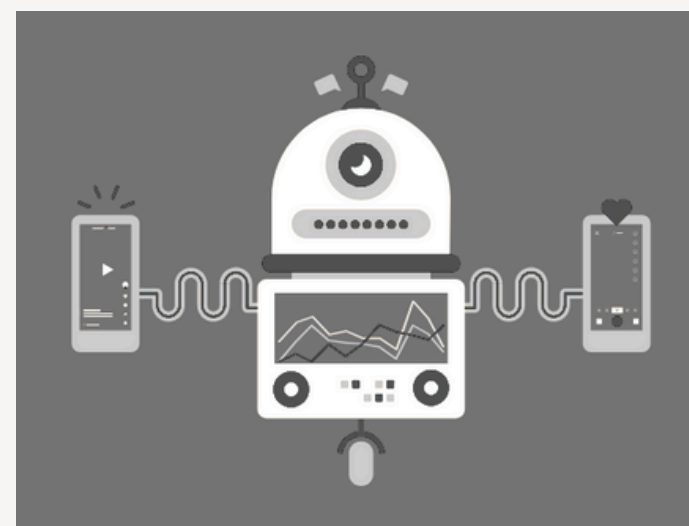
AMAZON Resolves uncertainty strategically

CONTROLS

- Data
- Pricing
- Recommendations

RESULT

It shapes behaviour through **guided choice**



TIKTOK Produces uncertainty algorithmically

CONTROLS

- Attention
- Perception
- Content visibility

RESULT

It shapes what becomes **perceptible**

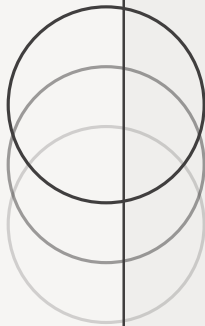
PAGE 3

Figure 1. Cracking the Amazon Algorithm: How to Boost Product Visibility and Sales, Natasha, <https://www.42signals.com/blog/optimize-for-amazon-algorithm/>
Figure 2. How the TikTok algorithm works in 2025, Mahnoor Sheikh, <https://sproutsocial.com/insights/tiktok-algorithm/>

State-Driven Governance

It is a system in which the government holds primary power over political, social, and informational structures:

- Centralized decision-making
- Strong regulatory frameworks
- Government-led digital infrastructure
- Policy-driven technological adoption
- Public sector control over key data systems



AI-generated images

	North Korea	Nepal
Type of Uncertainty	Is manufactured by the state	Emerges from society & politics
Information Flow	Controlled, scarce	Open, overloaded
Technology Role	Restricts uncertainty	Creates uncertainty
Youth’s Influence	Limited	High (Gen Z reshapes events)
Morphological Pattern	Stable, rigid, predictable	Fluid, shifting, dynamic

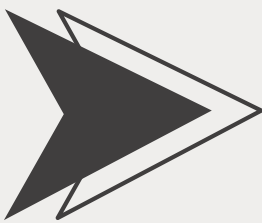
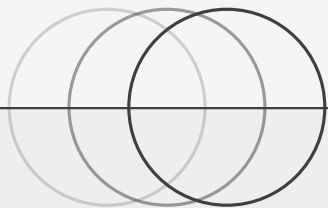
Digital Power Concentration: Implications, Scenarios and Regulatory Responses



DEMOCRATIC MECHANISMS

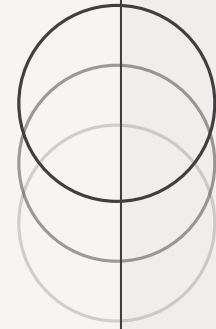
ACCOUNTABILITY	ANTITRUST
• Political sphere • Governors answerable to citizens • Transparency in data collection/use	• Economic sphere • Prevents power concentration • Necessary when competition erodes

RESPONSES DIGITAL SOVEREIGNTY (GDPR, AI ACT) AND REVIVING ANTITRUST TRADITION



IN CONCLUSION: WHO CONTROLS UNCERTAINTY, AND THUS SOCIETY?

Democratic control over uncertainty is equal to controlling the **infrastructure of information**, not just information itself



REFERENCES

- Luciano Floridi, Who controls society today?, 2025.
- Andrea Coveri et al., Monopoly Capital in the time of digital platforms: a radical approach to the Amazon case, 2022.
- Julia Salles, Affect and prediction in short-video social media recommendation algorithm: TikTok and the missing half second, 2025.
- Mikołaj Artur Dębicki, Oligopoly of Big-Tech companies despite global mistrust, 2022.

THANK YOU